



COVER STORY: INDIA'S BEST AND WORST STATES

REFORMS PAY APATHY DRAGS 34

The sixth State of States Report reveals that reforms pay and inaction sinks the state. The rankings reflect the reality that it is sustained reforms not free sops that deliver long lasting growth.

North Ahead 50

A new cluster of states led by Delhi, Himachal Pradesh and the old war-horse Punjab is leading the race for investment and consumption.

Inclusive Inflation 52

Since 2006-07, Bharat's inflation has been far higher than India's inflation, reinforcing the point that poor in rural India are suffering more.

India in Diversity 56

Numbers once again prove the diversified status of Indian states: 39.9 per cent of Orissa's people live in poverty while the figure for Punjab is 5.2.

Shackled by Sloth 60

The first-ever ranking of Lok Sabha Constituencies reveals politicians deliver better when located south of the Vindhyas while a combination of slothful politics holds back others.

STATES: ORISSA

For God's Sake 30

The recent incidents of violence in the state reach unprecedented levels while the political leadership's failure only widens the chasm of hatred.



MANEESH AGNIHOTRI

NATION: NUCLEAR DEAL

Free at Last 19



India wins a diplomatic battle to end the nuclear apartheid against it and sealing its strategic ties with the US.

Interview with Pranab Mukherjee.

NEIGHBOURS: PAKISTAN

Mr President 75



Asif Zardari emerges as the real power in Pakistan after his election as President. The doubt is: Is he really cut out for the task?

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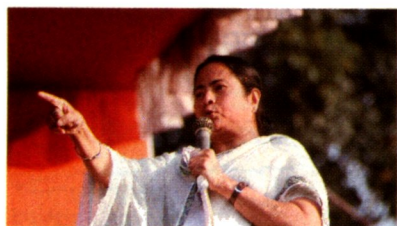
NATION: JUDICIARY

Judges on Trial 26

The mounting allegations of corruption against judges across the country stress the need for an institutional mechanism to ensure judicial accountability and public confidence in the judiciary.



NATION: SINGUR CRISIS



The Curse of Didigiri 24

By espousing the cause of the displaced farmers, Mamata Banerjee was not taking on India's most respected business house but West Bengal's Left Front Government. The Tatas have the option to shift out but the Marxists could face a real threat of being turfed out.

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Jobs Today 94

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